Winter option 2

What we are eating

- **Lunch, Mon to Wed:** Polish potato salad
- **Lunch, Thu and Fri (and Wednesday's dinner):** Lentil soup
- **Dinner, Mon and Tue:** Vegetarian bibimbap
- **Dinner, Thu and Fri:** Zapiekanka
- **Breakfast:** Egg muffins **Snack:** Granola bars
- **His meat, cooked separately:** Ginger pork (shogayaki), added to his lunches and to Wednesday's dinner. Everything else is vegetarian.
- **Weekend:** Borscht for lunch and Tofu stir fry for dinner, both days; eggs on toast for breakfast.

The week at a glance

DAYS	BREAKFAST	LUNCH (PACKED)	SNACK	DINNER	DAY TOTAL
Mon, Tue	**Egg muffins** **HIM** 2 muffins + 2 slices sourdough + Greek yogurt 175 g 510 kcal, 41 g **HER** 2 muffins + 1 slice sourdough + 1 tsp butter + apple 390 kcal, 20 g	**Polish potato salad** **HIM** 4 parts + his ginger pork 703 kcal, 41 g **HER** 3 parts + cottage cheese 125 g 465 kcal, 27 g	**Granola bars** **HIM** 1 bar + cottage cheese 125 g 372 kcal, 21 g **HER** 1 bar + cottage cheese 125 g 372 kcal, 21 g	**Vegetarian bibimbap** **HIM** 4 parts 592 kcal, 29 g **HER** 3 parts 444 kcal, 21 g	**HIM 2177 kcal**, 132 g **HER 1671 kcal**, 90 g
Wed	**Egg muffins** **HIM** 2 muffins + 2 slices sourdough + Greek yogurt 175 g 510 kcal, 41 g **HER** 2 muffins + 1 slice sourdough + 1 tsp butter + apple 390 kcal, 20 g	**Polish potato salad** **HIM** 4 parts + his ginger pork 703 kcal, 41 g **HER** 3 parts + cottage cheese 125 g 465 kcal, 27 g	**Granola bars** **HIM** 1 bar + cottage cheese 125 g 372 kcal, 21 g **HER** 1 bar + cottage cheese 125 g 372 kcal, 21 g	**Lentil soup** **HIM** 4 parts + his ginger pork + 1 slice sourdough 692 kcal, 49 g **HER** 3 parts + 1 slice sourdough + cheddar 30 g 507 kcal, 26 g	**HIM 2277 kcal**, 152 g **HER 1734 kcal**, 95 g
Thu, Fri	**Egg muffins** **HIM** 2 muffins + 2 slices sourdough + Greek yogurt 175 g 510 kcal, 41 g **HER** 2 muffins + 1 slice sourdough + 1 tsp butter + apple 390 kcal, 20 g	**Lentil soup** **HIM** 4 parts + his ginger pork + 1 slice sourdough 692 kcal, 49 g **HER** 3 parts + 1 slice sourdough + cheddar 30 g 507 kcal, 26 g	**Granola bars** **HIM** 1 bar + cottage cheese 125 g 372 kcal, 21 g **HER** 1 bar + cottage cheese 125 g 372 kcal, 21 g	**Zapiekanka** **HIM** 4 parts + Greek yogurt 175 g 621 kcal, 38 g **HER** 3 parts + Greek yogurt 175 g 498 kcal, 33 g	**HIM 2195 kcal**, 149 g **HER 1767 kcal**, 101 g
Sat	**Eggs on toast** **HIM** 2 eggs, 2 slices sourdough, 1 tsp butter, Greek yogurt 175 g 561 kcal, 37 g **HER** 2 eggs, 1 slice sourdough, 1 tsp butter, apple 406 kcal, 16 g	**Borscht** **HIM** 4 parts + the last of his ginger pork + 1 slice sourdough + 1 boiled egg 629 kcal, 34 g **HER** 3 parts + 1 slice sourdough + 2 boiled eggs 491 kcal, 22 g	**Granola bars** **HIM** 1 bar + cottage cheese 125 g 372 kcal, 21 g **HER** 1 bar + cottage cheese 125 g 372 kcal, 21 g	**Tofu stir fry** **HIM** 4 parts + 1 1/4 cup brown rice 608 kcal, 31 g **HER** 3 parts + 1 cup brown rice 470 kcal, 24 g	**HIM 2170 kcal**, 123 g **HER 1738 kcal**, 83 g
Sun	**Eggs on toast** **HIM** 2 eggs, 2 slices sourdough, 1 tsp butter, Greek yogurt 175 g 561 kcal, 37 g **HER** 2 eggs, 1 slice sourdough, 1 tsp butter, apple 406 kcal, 16 g	**Borscht** **HIM** 4 parts + 1 slice sourdough + 1 boiled egg 484 kcal, 18 g **HER** 3 parts + 1 slice sourdough + 2 boiled eggs 491 kcal, 22 g	**Granola bars** **HIM** 1 bar + cottage cheese 125 g 372 kcal, 21 g **HER** 1 bar + cottage cheese 125 g 372 kcal, 21 g	**Tofu stir fry** **HIM** 4 parts + 1 1/4 cup brown rice 608 kcal, 31 g **HER** 3 parts + 1 cup brown rice 470 kcal, 24 g	**HIM 2025 kcal**, 107 g **HER 1738 kcal**, 83 g

"4 parts" and "3 parts" are the his and hers shares of a cooked dish. Numbers are kcal and grams of protein.

The rhythm

Sunday, about 2 hours

1. Start with lentil soup (about 55 min). Make the recipe once (6 servings).
2. Then egg muffins (about 40 min). Make 2 x the recipe (24 muffins).
3. Then Polish potato salad (about 30 min). Make the recipe once (6 servings).
4. Then ginger pork (shogayaki), his meat for the week (about 20 min). Make 2 x the recipe (4 servings).
5. Then granola bars (25 min of work plus 2 hours chilling). Make 1 1/2 x the recipe (15 bars).
6. Box everything. Lentil soup for Thursday and Friday goes in the freezer; Wednesday's dinner portion can stay in the fridge.

The rest of the week

Monday	Cook vegetarian bibimbap (about 50 min). Dinner tonight and tomorrow.
Tuesday	No cooking. Leftovers from Monday.
Wednesday	Lentil soup from the fridge for dinner. Move Thursday's lunch boxes from the freezer to the fridge.
Thursday	Cook Zapiekanka (about 30 min). Dinner tonight and tomorrow. Move Friday's lunch boxes to the fridge.
Friday	No cooking.
Saturday	Midday: make borscht (about 45 min) for today's and tomorrow's lunch. Evening: cook tofu stir fry (about 25 min) for tonight's and tomorrow's dinner. Breakfast both days is eggs on toast.
Sunday	Leftovers from Saturday for lunch and dinner. Afternoon: prep the next option.

Groceries used: $203.32 for both of you for the seven days ($101.66 each). Buying every pack new costs about $346.39 at the till; most of the difference stays in the pantry for later options.

Shopping list: Winter option 2

For both of you, Monday to Sunday. Save-On-Foods prices seen Nov 10, 2026. Check the fridge and pantry first: oats, rice, soy sauce, honey, peanut butter and oil last for several options.

From H Mart (3147 Douglas St), not priced

Gochujang (Korean chili paste); Cooking sake (or any dry sake). Tofu, ginger, green onions and mushrooms are usually cheaper there too.

Pantry check (not on the list below)

Salt, pepper, neutral cooking oil, sugar or brown sugar, flour, cornstarch, vinegar, plus: cumin, coriander, paprika, bay leaves, dried basil, oregano, vanilla, cinnamon, sunflower seeds, coconut flakes, sesame seeds, ketchup, smoked paprika, celery seeds, red wine vinegar, chili paste (sambal oelek).

ITEM	NEED	BUY	PACK PRICE	COST OF AMOUNT USED
Produce				
☐ Ambrosia apple	8	8 x each, about 207 g	$0.91	$7.28
☐ Baby spinach (Western Family)	343 g	3 x 142 g	$4.99	$12.05
☐ Bean sprouts	120 g	1 x 227 g	$2.99	$1.58
☐ Beets, loose	454 g	loose, by weight	$0.66/100 g	$3.00
☐ Carrots	330 g	1 x 5 lb bag	$7.99	$1.16
☐ Celery	150 g	1 x bunch, about 675 g	$5.49	$1.22
☐ Fresh dill	0.8 bunch	1 x bunch	$3.99	$3.19
☐ Fresh ginger	75 g	loose, by weight	$0.66/100 g	$0.49
☐ Garlic	1.2 bulb	1 x 3 bulbs	$1.29	$0.52
☐ Grape tomatoes	220 g	1 x 284 g	$3.99	$3.09
☐ Green bell pepper	1	1 x each	$2.11	$2.11
☐ Green kale	1 bunch	1 x bunch	$4.49	$4.49
☐ Green onions	1.5 bunch	2 x bunch	$2.49	$3.74
☐ Lemon	1	1 x each	$0.99	$0.99
☐ Red bell pepper	1	1 x each	$2.98	$2.98
☐ White mushrooms, loose	415 g	loose, by weight	$1.32/100 g	$5.48
☐ Yellow onions	800 g	1 x 3 lb bag	$4.99	$2.93
☐ Yellow potatoes	1.95 kg	1 x 10 lb bag	$6.99	$3.01
Meat & deli				
☐ Pork loin chops, boneless, value pack	680 g	1 x about 984 g	$16.25	$11.23
Dairy & eggs				
☐ Cottage cheese 2% (Dairyland)	2.12 kg	3 x 750 g	$8.25	$23.38
☐ Extra firm tofu (Sunrise)	3.42 block	4 x 350 g	$3.99	$13.65
☐ Feta (Tre Stelle)	76 g	1 x 375 g	$8.99	$1.82
☐ Greek yogurt, plain 2% (Olympic)	1.93 kg	2 x 1.75 kg	$12.29	$13.52
☐ Large white eggs	43	3 x 18	$7.45	$17.80
☐ Medium cheddar block (Western Family)	240 g	1 x 600 g	$8.49	$3.40
☐ Salted butter (Western Family)	45 g	1 x 454 g	$6.69	$0.66
☐ Sour cream 14% (Dairyland)	90 mL	1 x 500 mL	$4.85	$0.87
Grains & bakery				
☐ Classic baguette (Bake Shop)	1	1 x 350 g	$3.49	$3.49
☐ Green lentils, bulk bin	400 g	loose, by weight	$0.89/100 g	$3.56
☐ Large flake oats (Rogers)	270 g	1 x 1 kg	$5.00	$1.35
☐ Long grain brown rice (Western Family)	292 g	1 x 907 g	$3.99	$1.29
☐ Quinoa, bulk bin	115 g	loose, by weight	$1.49/100 g	$1.71
☐ Sourdough bread, sliced (Bake Shop)	31 slice	3 x 567 g, about 12 slices	$3.99	$10.31
Pantry & cans				
☐ Canned peas (Western Family)	1 can	1 x 398 mL can	$2.59	$2.59
☐ Diced tomatoes in juice (Western Family)	400 mL	1 x 796 mL can	$2.39	$1.20
☐ Dijon mustard (Western Family)	5 mL	1 x 325 mL	$3.99	$0.06
☐ Extra virgin olive oil (Western Family)	75 mL	1 x 1 L	$15.99	$1.20
☐ Liquid honey (Western Family)	297 g	1 x 1 kg	$14.79	$4.39
☐ Mayonnaise (Western Family)	45 mL	1 x 890 mL	$6.99	$0.35
☐ Mini semi-sweet chocolate chips (Chipits)	90 g	1 x 270 g	$6.79	$2.26
☐ Mirin (Kikkoman Kotteri)	60 mL	1 x 296 mL	$6.99	$1.42
☐ Natural smooth peanut butter (Western Family)	128 g	1 x 1 kg	$5.99	$0.76
☐ Natural whole almonds, bulk bin	202 g	loose, by weight	$1.99/100 g	$4.03
☐ Polskie ogorki dill pickles (Bick's)	4 pickles	1 x 1 L jar, about 12 pickles	$6.99	$2.33
☐ Pure sesame oil (Kosa)	55 mL	1 x 185 mL	$3.99	$1.19
☐ Soy sauce, less sodium (Western Family)	150 mL	1 x 450 mL	$3.49	$1.16
☐ Tomato paste (Hunt's)	45 mL	1 x 156 mL can	$1.99	$0.57
☐ Vegetable broth, low sodium (Western Family)	2.45 L	3 x 946 mL	$2.49	$6.45
Allowance for spices, oil, vinegar and the H Mart items below (my estimate, not priced)				**$6.00**
Groceries used for this option, both of you				**$203.32**
At the till if every pack is bought new (the remainder carries into later weeks)				**$346.39**

Cook and split: Winter option 2

In cooking order. The outline is a reminder in my words; follow the linked recipe for amounts of seasoning and exact steps.

Polish potato salad SUNDAY

For Mon, Tue and Wed lunches · Make the recipe once (6 servings) · about 30 min · full recipe: polonist.com/polish-potato-salad (Polonist)

BUY FOR IT 1.5 kg yellow potatoes; 5 large white eggs; 150 g yellow onions; 4 pickles polskie ogorki dill pickles; 1 can canned peas; 1 ambrosia apple; 45 mL mayonnaise; 5 mL dijon mustard; 0.5 bunch fresh dill. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.

OUTLINE 1. Boil the potatoes and the eggs; cool and cube both. 2. Chop the pickles and onion finely; cube the apple. 3. Fold everything with the drained peas, mayonnaise, mustard and plenty of dill.

SPLIT Divide the whole batch into 3 his-and-hers pairs (Mon, Tue and Wed lunches). Fill his 4 parts to her 3: his is about 1.1 of the recipe's servings, hers about 0.86.

SIDES Him: nothing extra. Her: cottage cheese 125 g.

KEEP The page only says to keep it refrigerated. My guidance: 3 days.

REHEAT Eat cold.

ALLERGENS Eggs, mustard

NOTE Polish salatka with apple and peas. Costed with Bick's Polskie ogorki; a Polish deli's kiszone are closer to what the author means.

Ginger pork (shogayaki) SUNDAY

For his five lunches and Wednesday's dinner · Make 2 x the recipe (4 servings) · about 20 min · full recipe: justonecookbook.com/ginger-pork-shogayaki (Just One Cookbook)

BUY FOR IT 60 mL soy sauce, less sodium; 60 mL mirin; 60 g fresh ginger; 200 g yellow onions; 680 g pork loin chops, boneless, value pack. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.

OUTLINE 1. Mix soy, mirin, sake, sugar, ginger juice and a little grated onion. 2. Dust thin pork slices lightly with flour. 3. Sear the pork, add the sliced onion, pour in the sauce and coat.

SPLIT For him only. Portion into 6: a 0.6 serving portion (about 100 g pork) each, one for every lunch box and one for Wednesday's dinner. The remaining 0.4 servings goes on his weekend lunch. Keep Monday to Wednesday's in the fridge and freeze the rest.

SIDES Goes on top of his portion of whatever the lunch is. Hers stays vegetarian.

KEEP 3 days in the fridge or a month in the freezer (author).

REHEAT Microwave 60 to 90 s.

ALLERGENS Soy, wheat

H MART Cooking sake (or any dry sake)

NOTE Cooked only for him. The recipe serves 2, so this plan doubles it. Slice the loin chops thin yourself. Sake is not costed.

Egg muffins SUNDAY

For breakfasts, Mon to Fri · Make 2 x the recipe (24 muffins) · about 40 min · full recipe: wellplated.com/healthy-breakfast-egg-muffins (Well Plated)

BUY FOR IT 60 g baby spinach; 1 red bell pepper; 1 green bell pepper; 220 g grape tomatoes; 20 large white eggs; 76 g feta. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.

OUTLINE 1. Divide spinach, peppers and tomatoes among greased muffin cups. 2. Whisk eggs, whites and seasoning; pour over and top with feta. 3. Bake at 350 F about 25 min.

SPLIT Each weekday: 2 muffins for him, 2 muffins for her. 4 left over for the weekend or the freezer.

SIDES Him: 2 slices sourdough, Greek yogurt 175 g. Her: 1 slice sourdough, 1 tsp butter, apple.

KEEP 3 days in the fridge, 3 months in the freezer (author). Freeze Thursday's and Friday's.

REHEAT Microwave 30 to 45 s from the fridge, about 60 s from frozen.

ALLERGENS Eggs, milk (feta)

NOTE The tomatoes are baked in. To keep his completely tomato-free, leave them out of half the cups.

Granola bars SUNDAY

For snacks, Mon to Fri · Make 1 1/2 x the recipe (15 bars) · about 135 min · full recipe: wellplated.com/healthy-granola-bars (Well Plated)

BUY FOR IT	270 g large flake oats; 202 g natural whole almonds, bulk bin; 255 g liquid honey; 128 g natural smooth peanut butter; 90 g mini semi-sweet chocolate chips. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Toast oats, nuts and seeds. 2. Warm honey with peanut butter, stir in vanilla, cinnamon and the toasted mix; fold in chips. 3. Press firmly into a lined pan, chill 2 hours, cut into 10.
SPLIT	Every day including the weekend: 1 bar for him, 1 bar for her. 1 left over for the weekend or the freezer.
SIDES	Him: cottage cheese 125 g. Her: cottage cheese 125 g.
KEEP	1 week at room temperature, 2 weeks in the fridge, 2 months frozen (author).
REHEAT	Eat as is.
ALLERGENS	Peanuts, tree nuts; chocolate chips usually contain milk and soy

Vegetarian bibimbap MONDAY EVENING

For Mon and Tue dinners · Make the recipe once (4 servings) · about 50 min · full recipe: wellplated.com/vegetarian-bibimbap (Well Plated)

BUY FOR IT	1.15 block extra firm tofu; 45 mL soy sauce, less sodium; 42 g liquid honey; 45 mL pure sesame oil; 1 bunch green kale; 120 g bean sprouts; 0.4 bulb garlic; 15 mL extra virgin olive oil; 0.5 bunch green onions; 115 g white mushrooms, loose; 180 g carrots; 4 large white eggs; 115 g quinoa, bulk bin. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Crisp the tofu. 2. Blanch the kale and bean sprouts separately and dress each with soy and sesame oil. 3. Saute the mushrooms, then the carrot matchsticks. 4. Fry the eggs. Build bowls over quinoa and top with the gochujang sauce.
SPLIT	Divide the whole batch into 2 his-and-hers pairs (Mon and Tue dinners). Fill his 4 parts to her 3: his is about 1.1 of the recipe's servings, hers about 0.86.
SIDES	Him: nothing extra. Her: nothing extra.
KEEP	Vegetables and tofu keep up to 2 days (author), which is why this is a Monday and Tuesday dinner.
REHEAT	Rewarm the vegetables and tofu in a pan; fry the eggs fresh.
ALLERGENS	Soy, wheat (soy sauce), sesame, eggs
H MART	Gochujang (Korean chili paste)
NOTE	Meatless. Costed with white mushrooms in place of shiitake.

Lentil soup SUNDAY

For Wed dinner, Thu and Fri lunches · Make the recipe once (6 servings) · about 55 min · full recipe: recipetineats.com/lentil-soup (RecipeTin Eats)

BUY FOR IT	30 mL extra virgin olive oil; 150 g yellow onions; 0.2 bulb garlic; 150 g carrots; 150 g celery; 400 g green lentils, bulk bin; 400 mL diced tomatoes in juice; 1.5 L vegetable broth, low sodium; 1 lemon. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Soften onion and garlic, then carrot and celery, slowly. 2. Add lentils, tomato, broth and spices; simmer about 35 min. 3. Blitz a little of it to thicken, finish with lemon.
SPLIT	Divide the whole batch into 3 his-and-hers pairs (Wed dinner, Thu and Fri lunches). Fill his 4 parts to her 3: his is about 1.1 of the recipe's servings, hers about 0.86.
SIDES	Him: 1 slice sourdough. Her: 1 slice sourdough, cheddar 30 g.
KEEP	5 days in the fridge, 3 months in the freezer (author).
REHEAT	Microwave 2 to 3 min with a splash of water.
ALLERGENS	None of the major allergens (check the broth label)
NOTE	Meatless (made with vegetable broth) and the cheapest pot in the plan.

Zapiekanka THURSDAY EVENING

For Thu and Fri dinners · Make the recipe once (2 servings) · about 30 min · full recipe: polonist.com/polish-zapiekanka (Polonist)

BUY FOR IT	1 classic baguette; 300 g white mushrooms, loose; 80 g yellow onions; 150 g medium cheddar block. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Halve the baguette lengthwise and scoop out a little crumb. 2. Saute chopped mushrooms and onion 7 to 10 min; season. 3. Fill the bread, cover with grated cheese and bake until golden. 4. Finish with ketchup.
SPLIT	Divide the whole batch into 2 his-and-hers pairs (Thu and Fri dinners). Fill his 4 parts to her 3: his is about 0.57 of the recipe's servings, hers about 0.43.
SIDES	Him: Greek yogurt 175 g. Her: Greek yogurt 175 g.
KEEP	The page gives no storage time. My guidance: cook the mushroom filling once, keep it 2 days, and bake the second night's halves fresh.
REHEAT	Bake 8 to 10 min at 400 F rather than microwaving.
ALLERGENS	Wheat, milk
NOTE	Polish street food. Costed with medium cheddar; the recipe suggests a mild cheese such as gouda.

Borscht SATURDAY MIDDAY

For Saturday and Sunday lunches · Make the recipe once (6 servings) · about 45 min · full recipe: skinnytaste.com/borscht (Skinnytaste)

BUY FOR IT	30 mL extra virgin olive oil; 220 g yellow onions; 0.3 bulb garlic; 45 mL tomato paste; 454 g yellow potatoes; 454 g beets, loose; 950 mL vegetable broth, low sodium; 90 mL sour cream 14%; 0.3 bunch fresh dill. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Soften the onion; add garlic, tomato paste, smoked paprika and celery seed. 2. Add cubed potatoes and beets with the stock; simmer 20 min until tender. 3. Stir in the vinegar; serve with sour cream and dill.
SPLIT	Divide the whole batch into 2 his-and-hers pairs (Saturday and Sunday lunches). Fill his 4 parts to her 3: his is about 1.7 of the recipe's servings, hers about 1.3.
SIDES	Him: 1 slice sourdough, 1 boiled egg. Her: 1 slice sourdough, 2 boiled eggs.
KEEP	The author gives freezing directions (leave headspace, thaw overnight). Fridge life of 4 days is my guidance.
REHEAT	Microwave 2 to 3 min; add the sour cream and dill after.
ALLERGENS	Milk (sour cream topping)
NOTE	Made with vegetable stock (the recipe allows it). A light soup, so it comes with bread and eggs. This plan makes 1 1/2 times the recipe.

Tofu stir fry SATURDAY EVENING

For Saturday and Sunday dinners · Make the recipe once (4 servings) · about 25 min · full recipe: wellplated.com/tofu-stir-fry (Well Plated)

BUY FOR IT	2.27 block extra firm tofu; 45 mL soy sauce, less sodium; 0.3 bulb garlic; 1 bunch green onions; 15 g fresh ginger; 283 g baby spinach; 10 mL pure sesame oil. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Dry and cube the tofu; fry it in hot oil until golden, seasoning with soy. 2. Add garlic, scallions, ginger and chili paste. 3. Wilt in the spinach by the handful; finish with sesame seeds and sesame oil.
SPLIT	Divide the whole batch into 2 his-and-hers pairs (Saturday and Sunday dinners). Fill his 4 parts to her 3: his is about 1.1 of the recipe's servings, hers about 0.86.
SIDES	Him: 1 1/4 cup brown rice. Her: 1 cup brown rice.
KEEP	Up to 5 days in the fridge (author).
REHEAT	Microwave gently, 60 to 90 s (author).
ALLERGENS	Soy, wheat (soy sauce), sesame
NOTE	Meatless.